

RULE OF HATE

◀ REWIND

POISONED FLAMES: The burning Sabarmati Express



It was darkness at noon. Gujarat went up in flames after 57 VIP kar sevaks, including 25 women and 14 children, were burnt to death when a mob set fire to a coach of the Sabarmati Express on the outskirts of Godhra station on February 27. In the riots that followed, 790 Muslims and 254 Hindus were killed. The aftermath of the horrific massacre saw the BJP defending the state's Narendra Modi Government against charges of genocide.

FALLEN KINGS

On October 10, just three weeks before the dynasty's 55th anniversary, the Abdullahs of Jammu and Kashmir were routed in the assembly elections as Omar lost his stronghold—Ganderbal—in the October assembly elections. While father Farooq may have saved his seat, the National Conference were ousted from government, winning only 28 of 87 seats.

FIRST CUT

• Deputy Prime Minister, L.K. Advani flagged off the Delhi Metro's first trial run at Rail Corporation's Shastri Park Metro Depot.

• Direct flights between India and China were resumed after 40 years following the visit of the Chinese Prime Minister Zhu Rongji. Flights had been suspended after the 1962 war.

◀ DID YOU KNOW

The Central Government pushed through the Prevention of Terrorism Ordinance in what was only the third joint session of Parliament in India's history.